

Abigail Laver

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Education

University of Pennsylvania

PHD IN PSYCHOLOGY

- Advisor: Dr. John Trueswell

Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

Aug. 2023 - ongoing

University of Pennsylvania

B.A. IN PSYCHOLOGY WITH DISTINCTION, SUMMA CUM LAUDE

- Minor in Consumer Psychology

Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

Aug. 2017 - May. 2021

Research Experience

Language Learning and Multisensory Brain Lab

RESEARCH ASSOCIATE & LAB MANAGER

- PI: Dr. Richard Aslin

New Haven, CT

Jul. 2021 - Jul. 2023

Language Learning Lab, University of Pennsylvania

HONORS THESIS STUDENT

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

- PI: Dr. John Trueswell

Philadelphia, PA

Aug. 2020 - May 2021

Aug. 2018 - May 2021

Boundaries of Anxiety & Depression Lab, University of Pennsylvania

INDEPENDENT STUDY STUDENT

- PI: Dr. Ayelet Ruscio

Philadelphia, PA

Aug. 2019 - May 2020

Center for Autism Research, Children's Hospital of Philadelphia

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

- Supervisors: Lisa Yankowitz, Samantha Plate, & Victoria Petrulla

Philadelphia, PA

Jun. 2019 - Aug. 2019

Honors & Awards

- 2025 **Honorable Mention**, NSF Graduate Research Fellowship
- 2021 **Morris Viteles Award for Excellence in Undergraduate Research**, Department of Psychology, University of Pennsylvania
- 2021 **Phi Beta Kappa**, University of Pennsylvania
- 2021 **Pinkel Undergraduate Research Fund**, University of Pennsylvania
- 2020 **Lila Gleitman Undergraduate Summer Fellowship**, MindCORE, University of Pennsylvania
- 2019 **The Millstein Family Undergraduate Research Grant**, University of Pennsylvania
- 2019 **Psi Chi induction**, Psi Chi

Publications

- Laver, A.**, Yun, H., Kim, A.E., & Trueswell, J. C. (2025). *Distributional learning over meaningful words facilitates semantic inferences about previously unknown words*. Proceeding of the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.
- Isbilen, E. S., **Laver, A.**, Siegelman, N., Magnuson, J., & Aslin, R. N. (2025). Finding words in a sea of text: Word search as a measure of sensitivity to statistical regularities in reading. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition*.
- Isbilen, E. S., **Laver, A.**, Siegelman, N., & Aslin, R. N. (2024). Memory representations are flexibly adapted to orthographic systems: A comparison of English and Hebrew. *Brain Research*.

Conference Presentations

- Laver, A.**, Chen, J., Kim, A.E., & Trueswell, J.C. (2025). *Learning semantic features of distributional categories from known words*. Poster presentation at the 50th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston University.
- Karn, E., Sarrett, M. E., **Laver, A.**, Kim, A.E., Trueswell, J. C., & Toscano, J. C. (2024). *Decoding semantic categories for spoken words and images from EEG data*. Talk at the 23rd Annual Auditory Perception, Cognition, and Action Meeting, New York City, NY.
- Laver, A.**, Yun, H., Kim, A.E., & Trueswell, J.C. (2024). *Distributional history of pseudowords informs word-referent mappings, but only when language has semantic seeds*. Poster presentation at the 49th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston University.
- Isbilen, E. S., **Laver, A.**, Siegelman, N., Magnuson, J., & Aslin, R. N. (2024). *Finding words in a sea of text: Word search as a measure of sensitivity to statistical regularities in reading*. Talk at Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning, San Sebastian, Spain.
- Isbilen, E. S., **Laver, A.**, Siegelman, N., & Aslin, R. N. (2024). Memory representations are flexibly adapted to orthographic systems: A comparison of English and Hebrew. Poster presentation at Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning, San Sebastian, Spain.
- Sharretts, R., Schell, T., **Laver, A.**, Adams, A., & Ruscio, A. M. (2020). *Mental health correlates of pragmatic prospection*. Poster presentation at the annual meeting of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies, Philadelphia, PA.
- Yankowitz, L. D., Petrulla, V., Meera, S. S., Plate, S., Pandey, J., Swanson, M., Pruett Jr., J., Cola, M., Edwards, M., Moshiri, L., **Laver, A.**, Bourneuf, C., Jaung, T., Tunc, B., Guthrie, W., Wang, L. A. L., Marrus, N., Hazlett, H. C., Botteron, K., Constantino, J. N., Dager, S. R., Estes, A., Zwaigenbaum, L., Piven, J., Schultz, R. T., Parish-Morris, J., & the IBIS Network. (2020, March). *Canonical babbling differences in infants at high- and low-risk for ASD at 6 and 12 months*. Talk at the Meeting on Language in Autism, Durham, NC.

Teaching

University of Pennsylvania

TEACHING ASSISTANT: LANGUAGE & THOUGHT (PSYC 1310)

Spring 2025 & Fall 2025

- Instructor: Dr. John Trueswell

TEACHING ASSISTANT: PERCEPTION (PSYC 1340)

Fall 2024

- Instructor: Dr. David Brainard

Service

University of Pennsylvania

STUDENT MENTOR: DiVE IN (DIVERSITY AND EQUITY INITIATIVE IN THE MIND SCIENCES)

2024 & 2025

ORGANIZING COMMITTEE, ILST (INTEGRATED LANGUAGE SCIENCES & TECHNOLOGY) SEMINAR

Fall 2024 - ongoing